



According to the [deep dive analysis Tracking SDG7: The Energy Access report 2024](#) produced by Sustainable Energy for All, Africa's electricity access rate rose 15 percentage points between 2010 and 2022, from 44% to 59%; yet because population growth outpaced electrification, the number of Africans without electricity remained roughly unchanged at 591 million. The International Energy Agency further estimates that by 2023 around 750 million people worldwide still lacked electricity access, with more than 80% of them in Africa. Clean cooking access tells a similar story: while 74% of the global population had access to clean cooking fuels and technologies by 2022, some 923 million people in Sub-Saharan Africa – roughly three out of every four – still relied on polluting fuels such as wood and charcoal, a gap that is projected to keep widening without accelerated action.

Uganda reflects this wider energy challenge. [Per the IEA's Uganda 2023 country report](#), only around 30% of the population had access to electricity and less than 6% had access to clean cooking fuels as of 2022 – among the lowest rates in Sub-Saharan Africa. Of that electricity access, only about 20% came from the national grid, with a further 10% served by solar home systems and another 20% relying on basic solar lanterns. [Uganda's 2025 National Energy Compact](#) reports rural electricity access at just 43% against urban access of 80%, and sets a national target of 85% access by 2030, while the country's National Energy Policy (2023) targets universal electricity access and only 50% clean cooking access by 2040. The challenge, as with water, is not simply whether power lines or cookstoves exist, but whether households particularly in rural and off-grid communities can access energy that is affordable, reliable and clean.

For OEF, this gap presents a clear opportunity to advance access to affordable, reliable and clean energy as a practical pathway to building healthier, more productive and resilient communities in Uganda. OEF will focus on vulnerable and off-grid communities where limited energy access, climate risk and inadequate infrastructure intersect, supporting locally led, affordable and climate-resilient energy solutions from solar home systems and mini-grids to clean cookstoves while strengthening community capacity to sustain them. Through partnerships with communities, government, technical actors and funders, OEF will demonstrate practical, measurable and replicable solutions that contribute directly to its commitment to Access, Resilience and Impact.